



Pregnancy is a time of **blooming** and beauty, when your body is doing the most amazing thing possible—**creating** another human being. However, it also means that **your body** undergoes changes to **facilitate** the **growth** of the **baby**, and these can sometimes be less than desirable for you.

Common complaints

Common complaints in pregnancy

The complaints on the following pages highlight side effects that some women experience while pregnant. The common complaints experienced during pregnancy can be grouped into seven main types.

- 1. General symptoms** that are as simple as fatigue, difficulty in sleeping, protruding navel, nasal problems, blurred vision, swollen feet and ankles, fluid retention (edema), foot problems, and headaches.
- 2. Skin changes** such as heat rash and extremely itchy skin.
- 3. Breast problems**, including leaking fluid and clogged milk ducts.
- 4. Digestive problems** such as nausea, vomiting, hyperemesis gravidarum, heartburn, indigestion, constipation, and increased flatulence.
- 5. Heart and circulation problems** for example, dizziness, breathlessness, varicose veins, and hemorrhoids.
- 6. Aches and pains** such as numbness in hands, lower abdominal pressure, abdominal pains, carpal tunnel syndrome, backpain, sciatica, and restless legs.
- 7. Urinary and vaginal problems** which include yeast,

vaginal discharge and bleeding, urinary-tract infections, and the inability to urinate.

Dealing with common complaints

This section offers explanations and advice for dealing with the range of complaints you may or may not experience during pregnancy. Some are worse than others and some can be embraced as a sign of your belly getting bigger and your baby growing in size (protruding navel). Try to look at the issues you might be encountering as a positive sign that your pregnancy is progressing.

Illness and medications during pregnancy

When you're pregnant your immune system is suppressed slightly so that you don't reject the baby. This means that you might be more likely to get sick. If you are unwell during pregnancy it's important to know how to deal with an illness and which medications you can take. When you're pregnant, you should never take any type of medication on your own without consulting your doctor first—not even something that seems harmless enough, like acetaminophen or over-the-counter cold medication.